

Tools & Planners

How to pick a pomodoro timer

Five calm steps to find a timer you will actually reach for, app or one you can hold.

1

Step 1

Notice what pulls you away

Think about your last focus session that fell apart. Phone? Lost track of time? Never started? That tells you which kind of timer fits.

★ **Phone is the trap? Try a timer you can hold.**

2

Step 2

Make starting one tap or one flip

A pinned browser tab, a home screen widget, or a cube you flip on your desk. If setup takes more than a few seconds, you will skip it on a hard day.

★ **The best timer has the least friction.**

3

Step 3

Pick a block you can finish

Start with a block that feels almost too easy, even 10 minutes. Finishing a short block builds trust with yourself. Make it longer later.

★ **Any finished block counts.**

4

Step 4

Choose a sound you will not dread

A harsh alarm can make you jump, and a soft chime can slip past you. Try the sound once before a real session.

★ **A gentle early warning makes stopping easier.**

5

Step 5

Test it on a real task for a week

Use it on something you have been avoiding before you pay for anything. Notice if you reach for it on your own.

★ **If not, that is information, not failure.**

Good to know

25 minutes is not a rule

The classic rhythm is 25 minutes of work and a 5 minute break. Shorter blocks are a fine place to start when starting is the hard part.

★ **10 or 15 minutes is a real session.**



One tap, one task, one ring

Pick one timer and try it on one task today. Our ranked list of seven picks is on the site.

Save this for your next focus session

Full guide: link in bio